

SHORT-VOWEL CVC BINDER

Read it · Build it · Write it — the complete no-prep intervention binder for beginning and struggling readers.

Grades K–2

No prep

Print & reuse

Probes + data

A

short A

I

short I

O

short O

U

short U

e

short E

52

pages

30

practice pages

6

probes + data

2

AI Growth Eval



Ends with an **AI Growth Eval** — turn the scores you collected into this week's next three moves.

**Print once, reuse**

Sleeve it, hand out a dry-erase marker, use it all year.

**Sequence printed inside**

Slot it into the programme you already teach.

**Cited, not guessed**

The research behind it is named on the last page.

START HERE

HOW TO USE THIS BINDER

Five units, one short vowel each, in the order that keeps the confusable vowels apart.



Unit 1



Unit 2



Unit 3



Unit 4



Unit 5

The weekly loop

1. Print the practice pages once and sleeve them — students write with a dry-erase marker and the binder lasts all year. 2. Work one unit: six practice pages, in order, a few minutes a day. 3. Give the ten-word probe once a week and record it on that unit's data sheet. 4. Take the score to the AI Growth Eval at the back. 5. Move on at 8 of 10, twice in a row.

Why this sequence

Short **a** comes first because it appears in more early decodable words than any other short vowel. Short **e** comes last because **e** and **i** are the pair students most often confuse, and separating them reduces that collision. The sequence is printed here so you can slot this into whatever phonics programme you already teach instead of guessing what it assumes.

What is in every unit

A tab divider with the unit's picture words · read-it/build-it/write-it with pictures · the same without pictures · sound boxes · picture-and-word match · word-family sorting · sentence reading · a ten-word probe on its own student-facing page · a four-week data sheet.

Every target word in this binder is a true CVC word — one consonant, one short vowel, one consonant, no blends and no digraphs — verified by an automated check before publication.



SHORT A

cat • hat • bag • van • pan • map

One consonant, one short vowel, one consonant.

1 • short a

2 • short i

3 • short o

4 • short u

5 • short e



cat



hat



bag



van



pan



map

This unit at a glance

Six practice pages, a ten-word probe on its own student page, and a four-week data sheet. Work the unit until the probe shows 8 of 10 twice, then move to the next tab. The Growth Eval at the back of the binder works for every unit.

If a student is stuck here

Go back a step rather than forward. Practice 3 (sound boxes) before practice 1 rebuilds the sounds; practice 1 before practice 2 puts the picture support back. A student who cannot hear three separate sounds in a word is not ready for the writing pages yet — that is a segmenting gap, and the Growth Eval says what to do about it.

Every word in this unit uses the short a sound and nothing else — no other vowel leaks in — so a miss here means this sound, not a mix-up with the last tab.

6

practice pages

10

probe words

4

weeks of data

8/10

to move on

READ IT. BUILD IT. WRITE IT.

Say the word out loud. Push a letter into each box. Then write it on the line.

READ

BUILD

WRITE



cat

o

o

o



hat

o

o

o



bag

o

o

o



van

o

o

o



pan

o

o

o



map

o

o

o



Challenge: pick two words and say a whole sentence for each, out loud.

Colour a star for each word you read on your own



Teacher tally

 / 6

READ IT. BUILD IT. WRITE IT.

No pictures this time. Sound out each letter, then blend the whole word.

READ

BUILD

WRITE

1 **bat**



.....

2 **jam**



.....

3 **tap**



.....

4 **ran**



.....

5 **mad**



.....

6 **wag**



.....

Write your own

Think of one more word with the short a sound. Write it and draw it.

.....



Teacher note: if a student stalls here but flew through practice 1, the pictures were doing the decoding. Worth knowing — mark it on the data sheet.

TAP THE SOUNDS.

Your teacher says a word. Tap one box for each sound you hear, then write the letter in the box.

TEACHER — say these in order:

can

lap

fan

rat

gas

ham

1

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

2

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

3

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

4

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

5

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

6

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word



Three boxes, three sounds. Every word in this binder has exactly three.

Teacher note

Tapping before writing separates two problems. Taps three sounds but writes the wrong letter → a **letter-sound** gap. Cannot tap three sounds at all → a **segmenting** gap, and the sounds come before the spelling. Note which one you saw; the Growth Eval asks.

WHICH WORD MATCHES?

Read the word bank. Write the word that matches each picture on the line underneath it.

WORD BANK

map

pan

van

bag

hat

cat



.....



.....



.....



.....



.....



.....

Finished early? Turn the page over and draw one more short-a thing. Label it.

SORT BY THE ENDING.

Every word below ends in -at, -ap or -ag. Read each one, then write it in the right column.

WORD BANK

cat

hat

bat

mat

map

tap

nap

lap

bag

rag

tag

wag

-AT

.....

.....

.....

.....

-AP

.....

.....

.....

.....

-AG

.....

.....

.....

.....

Four words go in each column. If a column has five, read them again — one is in the wrong place.

Pick one word from each column and say it in a sentence.

.....

READ IT, THEN SHOW IT.

Read each sentence out loud. Circle every short-a word you find. Then draw what it says.

The cat sat on my hat.

Dad had jam in a pan.

A rat ran to the van.

DRAW SENTENCE 1

DRAW SENTENCE 2

DRAW SENTENCE 3

Teacher note: small joining words like "the", "on", "my", "a", "to" are not CVC target words — they are there so the sentence works. Only the circled words are the target.

Now write your own sentence with two short-a words.

.....

.....

READ THESE TEN WORDS.

Point to each word and read it out loud. Your teacher will listen and mark their own sheet — you just read.

cat**map****sad****pan****bag****hat****tap****rag****jam****van**

TEACHER: no prompts and no sounding-out help during the probe. Mark a word correct only if the student reads it accurately within about three seconds. Record on the data sheet, then use the Growth Eval.

DATE

.....

WEEK

.....

SCORE

— / 10

UNIT 1 PROBE • DATA SHEET

Ten words, read aloud, once a week. Circle each one read correctly. Score out of 10, then take the score to the Growth Eval.

Probe word	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4
cat	☐	☐	☐	☐
map	☐	☐	☐	☐
sad	☐	☐	☐	☐
pan	☐	☐	☐	☐
bag	☐	☐	☐	☐
hat	☐	☐	☐	☐
tap	☐	☐	☐	☐
rag	☐	☐	☐	☐
jam	☐	☐	☐	☐
van	☐	☐	☐	☐
Score / 10	_____	_____	_____	_____

What did you notice? (the eval page uses this)

Which sound slipped • speed or accuracy • did the miss change week to week • did they self-correct

.....

.....

Move-on signal: 8 of 10 across two probes in a row. Mastery criteria in phonics commonly sit at 80–90% accuracy; we ask for 80% twice rather than 90% once, so a single good day does not look like mastery.

SHORT I

pig • pin • six • lip • kid • bin

One consonant, one short vowel, one consonant.

1 • short a

2 • short i

3 • short o

4 • short u

5 • short e



pig



pin

6

six



lip



kid



bin

This unit at a glance

Six practice pages, a ten-word probe on its own student page, and a four-week data sheet. Work the unit until the probe shows 8 of 10 twice, then move to the next tab. The Growth Eval at the back of the binder works for every unit.

If a student is stuck here

Go back a step rather than forward. Practice 3 (sound boxes) before practice 1 rebuilds the sounds; practice 1 before practice 2 puts the picture support back. A student who cannot hear three separate sounds in a word is not ready for the writing pages yet — that is a segmenting gap, and the Growth Eval says what to do about it.

Every word in this unit uses the short i sound and nothing else — no other vowel leaks in — so a miss here means this sound, not a mix-up with the last tab.

6

practice pages

10

probe words

4

weeks of data

8/10

to move on

READ IT. BUILD IT. WRITE IT.

Say the word out loud. Push a letter into each box. Then write it on the line.

READ

BUILD

WRITE



pig



.....



pin



.....



six



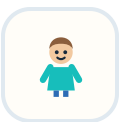
.....



lip



.....



kid



.....



bin



.....



Challenge: pick two words and say a whole sentence for each, out loud.

Colour a star for each word you read on your own



Teacher tally

 / 6

READ IT. BUILD IT. WRITE IT.

No pictures this time. Sound out each letter, then blend the whole word.

READ

BUILD

WRITE

1 **fit**



.....

2 **hit**



.....

3 **rib**



.....

4 **dig**



.....

5 **mix**



.....

6 **sit**



.....

Write your own

Think of one more word with the short i sound. Write it and draw it.

.....



Teacher note: if a student stalls here but flew through practice 1, the pictures were doing the decoding. Worth knowing — mark it on the data sheet.

TAP THE SOUNDS.

Your teacher says a word. Tap one box for each sound you hear, then write the letter in the box.

TEACHER — say these in order:

win

tip

fig

him

rip

lit

1

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

2

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

3

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

4

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

5

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

6

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word



Three boxes, three sounds. Every word in this binder has exactly three.

Teacher note

Tapping before writing separates two problems. Taps three sounds but writes the wrong letter → a **letter-sound** gap. Cannot tap three sounds at all → a **segmenting** gap, and the sounds come before the spelling. Note which one you saw; the Growth Eval asks.

WHICH WORD MATCHES?

Read the word bank. Write the word that matches each picture on the line underneath it.

WORD BANK

bin

kid

lip

six

pin

pig



.....



.....

6

.....



.....



.....



.....

Finished early? Turn the page over and draw one more short-i thing. Label it.

SORT BY THE ENDING.

Every word below ends in -ig, -ip or -in. Read each one, then write it in the right column.

WORD BANK

big

dig

fig

pig

dip

lip

rip

tip

bin

fin

pin

win

-ig

.....

.....

.....

.....

-ip

.....

.....

.....

.....

-in

.....

.....

.....

.....

Four words go in each column. If a column has five, read them again — one is in the wrong place.

Pick one word from each column and say it in a sentence.

.....

READ IT, THEN SHOW IT.

Read each sentence out loud. Circle every short-i word you find. Then draw what it says.

The pig sat in the bin.

A kid can dig in it.

I win if I hit six.

DRAW SENTENCE 1

DRAW SENTENCE 2

DRAW SENTENCE 3

Teacher note: small joining words like "the", "on", "my", "a", "to" are not CVC target words — they are there so the sentence works. Only the circled words are the target.

Now write your own sentence with two short-i words.

.....

.....

READ THESE TEN WORDS.

Point to each word and read it out loud. Your teacher will listen and mark their own sheet — you just read.

pig**six****lip****kid****bin****pin****hit****dig****mix****sit**

TEACHER: no prompts and no sounding-out help during the probe. Mark a word correct only if the student reads it accurately within about three seconds. Record on the data sheet, then use the Growth Eval.

DATE

.....

WEEK

.....

SCORE

— / 10

SHORT 1 • PROGRESS MONITORING

UNIT 2 PROBE • DATA SHEET

Ten words, read aloud, once a week. Circle each one read correctly. Score out of 10, then take the score to the Growth Eval.

Probe word	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4
pig	☐	☐	☐	☐
six	☐	☐	☐	☐
lip	☐	☐	☐	☐
kid	☐	☐	☐	☐
bin	☐	☐	☐	☐
pin	☐	☐	☐	☐
hit	☐	☐	☐	☐
dig	☐	☐	☐	☐
mix	☐	☐	☐	☐
sit	☐	☐	☐	☐
Score / 10	_____	_____	_____	_____

What did you notice? (the eval page uses this)

Which sound slipped • speed or accuracy • did the miss change week to week • did they self-correct

Move-on signal: 8 of 10 across two probes in a row. Mastery criteria in phonics commonly sit at 80–90% accuracy; we ask for 80% twice rather than 90% once, so a single good day does not look like mastery.



SHORT O

dog · box · mop · log · pot · fox

One consonant, one short vowel, one consonant.

1 · short a

2 · short i

3 · short o

4 · short u

5 · short e



dog



box



mop



log



pot



fox

This unit at a glance

Six practice pages, a ten-word probe on its own student page, and a four-week data sheet. Work the unit until the probe shows 8 of 10 twice, then move to the next tab. The Growth Eval at the back of the binder works for every unit.

If a student is stuck here

Go back a step rather than forward. Practice 3 (sound boxes) before practice 1 rebuilds the sounds; practice 1 before practice 2 puts the picture support back. A student who cannot hear three separate sounds in a word is not ready for the writing pages yet — that is a segmenting gap, and the Growth Eval says what to do about it.

Every word in this unit uses the short o sound and nothing else — no other vowel leaks in — so a miss here means this sound, not a mix-up with the last tab.

6

practice pages

10

probe words

4

weeks of data

8/10

to move on

READ IT. BUILD IT. WRITE IT.

Say the word out loud. Push a letter into each box. Then write it on the line.

READ

BUILD

WRITE



dog



.....



box



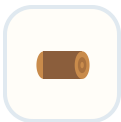
.....



mop



.....



log



.....



pot



.....



fox



.....



Challenge: pick two words and say a whole sentence for each, out loud.

Colour a star for each word you read on your own



Teacher tally

 / 6

READ IT. BUILD IT. WRITE IT.

No pictures this time. Sound out each letter, then blend the whole word.

READ

BUILD

WRITE

1 **hop**



.....

2 **top**



.....

3 **rob**



.....

4 **jog**



.....

5 **cot**



.....

6 **mom**



.....

Write your own

Think of one more word with the short o sound. Write it and draw it.

.....



Teacher note: if a student stalls here but flew through practice 1, the pictures were doing the decoding. Worth knowing — mark it on the data sheet.

TAP THE SOUNDS.

Your teacher says a word. Tap one box for each sound you hear, then write the letter in the box.

TEACHER — say these in order:

hot

dot

sob

rod

job

nod

1

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

2

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

3

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

4

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

5

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

6

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word



Three boxes, three sounds. Every word in this binder has exactly three.

Teacher note

Tapping before writing separates two problems. Taps three sounds but writes the wrong letter → a **letter-sound** gap. Cannot tap three sounds at all → a **segmenting** gap, and the sounds come before the spelling. Note which one you saw; the Growth Eval asks.

WHICH WORD MATCHES?

Read the word bank. Write the word that matches each picture on the line underneath it.

WORD BANK

fox

pot

log

mop

box

dog



.....



.....



.....



.....



.....



.....

Finished early? Turn the page over and draw one more short-o thing. Label it.

SORT BY THE ENDING.

Every word below ends in -og, -op or -ot. Read each one, then write it in the right column.

WORD BANK

dog

fog

jog

log

hop

mop

pop

top

dot

hot

pot

not

-OG

.....

.....

.....

.....

-OP

.....

.....

.....

.....

-OT

.....

.....

.....

.....

Four words go in each column. If a column has five, read them again — one is in the wrong place.

Pick one word from each column and say it in a sentence.

.....

READ IT, THEN SHOW IT.

Read each sentence out loud. Circle every short-o word you find. Then draw what it says.

The dog sat on a log.

Mom put the mop in the box.

A fox can hop on top.

DRAW SENTENCE 1

DRAW SENTENCE 2

DRAW SENTENCE 3

Teacher note: small joining words like "the", "on", "my", "a", "to" are not CVC target words — they are there so the sentence works. Only the circled words are the target.

Now write your own sentence with two short-o words.

.....

.....

READ THESE TEN WORDS.

Point to each word and read it out loud. Your teacher will listen and mark their own sheet — you just read.

dog**box****mop****log****pot****fox****hop****top****hot****job**

TEACHER: no prompts and no sounding-out help during the probe. Mark a word correct only if the student reads it accurately within about three seconds. Record on the data sheet, then use the Growth Eval.

DATE

.....

WEEK

.....

SCORE

— / 10

UNIT 3 PROBE • DATA SHEET

Ten words, read aloud, once a week. Circle each one read correctly. Score out of 10, then take the score to the Growth Eval.

Probe word	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4
dog	☐	☐	☐	☐
box	☐	☐	☐	☐
mop	☐	☐	☐	☐
log	☐	☐	☐	☐
pot	☐	☐	☐	☐
fox	☐	☐	☐	☐
hop	☐	☐	☐	☐
top	☐	☐	☐	☐
hot	☐	☐	☐	☐
job	☐	☐	☐	☐
Score / 10	_____	_____	_____	_____

What did you notice? (the eval page uses this)

Which sound slipped • speed or accuracy • did the miss change week to week • did they self-correct

.....

.....

Move-on signal: 8 of 10 across two probes in a row. Mastery criteria in phonics commonly sit at 80–90% accuracy; we ask for 80% twice rather than 90% once, so a single good day does not look like mastery.



SHORT U

bug · sun · cup · bus · mug · rug

One consonant, one short vowel, one consonant.

1 · short a

2 · short i

3 · short o

4 · short u

5 · short e



bug



sun



cup



bus



mug



rug

This unit at a glance

Six practice pages, a ten-word probe on its own student page, and a four-week data sheet. Work the unit until the probe shows 8 of 10 twice, then move to the next tab. The Growth Eval at the back of the binder works for every unit.

If a student is stuck here

Go back a step rather than forward. Practice 3 (sound boxes) before practice 1 rebuilds the sounds; practice 1 before practice 2 puts the picture support back. A student who cannot hear three separate sounds in a word is not ready for the writing pages yet — that is a segmenting gap, and the Growth Eval says what to do about it.

Every word in this unit uses the short u sound and nothing else — no other vowel leaks in — so a miss here means this sound, not a mix-up with the last tab.

6

practice pages

10

probe words

4

weeks of data

8/10

to move on

READ IT. BUILD IT. WRITE IT.

Say the word out loud. Push a letter into each box. Then write it on the line.

READ

BUILD

WRITE



bug

o o o



sun

o o o



cup

o o o



bus

o o o



mug

o o o



rug

o o o



Challenge: pick two words and say a whole sentence for each, out loud.

Colour a star for each word you read on your own



Teacher tally

 / 6

READ IT. BUILD IT. WRITE IT.

No pictures this time. Sound out each letter, then blend the whole word.

READ

BUILD

WRITE

1 **run**



.....

2 **hug**



.....

3 **cut**



.....

4 **tub**



.....

5 **mud**



.....

6 **gum**



.....

Write your own

Think of one more word with the short u sound. Write it and draw it.

.....



Teacher note: if a student stalls here but flew through practice 1, the pictures were doing the decoding. Worth knowing — mark it on the data sheet.

TAP THE SOUNDS.

Your teacher says a word. Tap one box for each sound you hear, then write the letter in the box.

TEACHER — say these in order:

fun

bun

hut

rub

sum

dug

1

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

2

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

3

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

4

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

5

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

6

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word



Three boxes, three sounds. Every word in this binder has exactly three.

Teacher note

Tapping before writing separates two problems. Taps three sounds but writes the wrong letter → a **letter-sound** gap. Cannot tap three sounds at all → a **segmenting** gap, and the sounds come before the spelling. Note which one you saw; the Growth Eval asks.

WHICH WORD MATCHES?

Read the word bank. Write the word that matches each picture on the line underneath it.

WORD BANK

rug

mug

bus

cup

sun

bug



.....



.....



.....



.....



.....



.....

Finished early? Turn the page over and draw one more short-u thing. Label it.

SORT BY THE ENDING.

Every word below ends in -ug, -un or -ut. Read each one, then write it in the right column.

WORD BANK

bug

hug

mug

rug

bun

fun

run

sun

but

cut

hut

nut

-UG

.....

.....

.....

.....

-UN

.....

.....

.....

.....

-UT

.....

.....

.....

.....

Four words go in each column. If a column has five, read them again — one is in the wrong place.

Pick one word from each column and say it in a sentence.

.....

READ IT, THEN SHOW IT.

Read each sentence out loud. Circle every short-u word you find. Then draw what it says.

A bug sat on the rug.

The sun is fun for us.

I run to the bus.

DRAW SENTENCE 1

DRAW SENTENCE 2

DRAW SENTENCE 3

Teacher note: small joining words like "the", "on", "my", "a", "to" are not CVC target words — they are there so the sentence works. Only the circled words are the target.

Now write your own sentence with two short-u words.

.....

.....

READ THESE TEN WORDS.

Point to each word and read it out loud. Your teacher will listen and mark their own sheet — you just read.

bug**sun****cup****bus****mug****rug****run****hug****cut****tub**

TEACHER: no prompts and no sounding-out help during the probe. Mark a word correct only if the student reads it accurately within about three seconds. Record on the data sheet, then use the Growth Eval.

DATE

.....

WEEK

.....

SCORE

— / 10

UNIT 4 PROBE • DATA SHEET

Ten words, read aloud, once a week. Circle each one read correctly. Score out of 10, then take the score to the Growth Eval.

Probe word	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4
bug	☐	☐	☐	☐
sun	☐	☐	☐	☐
cup	☐	☐	☐	☐
bus	☐	☐	☐	☐
mug	☐	☐	☐	☐
rug	☐	☐	☐	☐
run	☐	☐	☐	☐
hug	☐	☐	☐	☐
cut	☐	☐	☐	☐
tub	☐	☐	☐	☐
Score / 10	_____	_____	_____	_____

What did you notice? (the eval page uses this)

Which sound slipped • speed or accuracy • did the miss change week to week • did they self-correct

.....

.....

Move-on signal: 8 of 10 across two probes in a row. Mastery criteria in phonics commonly sit at 80–90% accuracy; we ask for 80% twice rather than 90% once, so a single good day does not look like mastery.



SHORT E

bed • hen • ten • pen • jet • web

One consonant, one short vowel, one consonant.

1 • short a

2 • short i

3 • short o

4 • short u

5 • short e



bed



hen

10

ten



pen



jet



web

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Six practice pages, a ten-word probe on its own student page, and a four-week data sheet. Work the unit until the probe shows 8 of 10 twice, then move to the next tab. The Growth Eval at the back of the binder works for every unit.

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Every word in this unit uses the short e sound and nothing else — no other vowel leaks in — so a miss here means this sound, not a mix-up with the last tab.

6

practice pages

10

probe words

4

weeks of data

8/10

to move on

READ IT. BUILD IT. WRITE IT.

Say the word out loud. Push a letter into each box. Then write it on the line.

READ

BUILD

WRITE



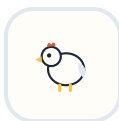
bed

o

o

o

.....



hen

o

o

o

.....



ten

o

o

o

.....



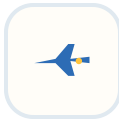
pen

o

o

o

.....



jet

o

o

o

.....



web

o

o

o

.....



Challenge: pick two words and say a whole sentence for each, out loud.

Colour a star for each word you read on your own



Teacher tally

 / 6

READ IT. BUILD IT. WRITE IT.

No pictures this time. Sound out each letter, then blend the whole word.

READ

BUILD

WRITE

1 **red**



.....

2 **net**



.....

3 **leg**



.....

4 **wet**



.....

5 **hem**



.....

6 **peg**



.....

Write your own

Think of one more word with the short e sound. Write it and draw it.

.....



Teacher note: if a student stalls here but flew through practice 1, the pictures were doing the decoding. Worth knowing — mark it on the data sheet.

TAP THE SOUNDS.

Your teacher says a word. Tap one box for each sound you hear, then write the letter in the box.

TEACHER — say these in order:

bet

den

get

led

met

yes

1

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

2

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

3

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

4

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

5

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word

6

--	--	--

say the sounds · then write the word



Three boxes, three sounds. Every word in this binder has exactly three.

Teacher note

Tapping before writing separates two problems. Taps three sounds but writes the wrong letter → a **letter-sound** gap. Cannot tap three sounds at all → a **segmenting** gap, and the sounds come before the spelling. Note which one you saw; the Growth Eval asks.

WHICH WORD MATCHES?

Read the word bank. Write the word that matches each picture on the line underneath it.

WORD BANK

web

jet

pen

ten

hen

bed



.....



.....

10

.....



.....



.....



.....

Finished early? Turn the page over and draw one more short-e thing. Label it.

SORT BY THE ENDING.

Every word below ends in -ed, -en or -et. Read each one, then write it in the right column.

WORD BANK

bed

fed

led

red

den

hen

men

pen

bet

get

net

wet

-ed

.....

.....

.....

.....

-en

.....

.....

.....

.....

-et

.....

.....

.....

.....

Four words go in each column. If a column has five, read them again — one is in the wrong place.

Pick one word from each column and say it in a sentence.

.....

READ IT, THEN SHOW IT.

Read each sentence out loud. Circle every short-e word you find. Then draw what it says.

The hen sat on the bed.

I get a red pen.

Ten legs on the web are wet.

DRAW SENTENCE 1

DRAW SENTENCE 2

DRAW SENTENCE 3

Teacher note: small joining words like "the", "on", "my", "a", "to" are not CVC target words — they are there so the sentence works. Only the circled words are the target.

Now write your own sentence with two short-e words.

.....

.....

READ THESE TEN WORDS.

Point to each word and read it out loud. Your teacher will listen and mark their own sheet — you just read.

bed**hen****ten****pen****jet****web****red****leg****wet****get**

TEACHER: no prompts and no sounding-out help during the probe. Mark a word correct only if the student reads it accurately within about three seconds. Record on the data sheet, then use the Growth Eval.

DATE

.....

WEEK

.....

SCORE

— / 10

UNIT 5 PROBE • DATA SHEET

Ten words, read aloud, once a week. Circle each one read correctly. Score out of 10, then take the score to the Growth Eval.

Probe word	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4
bed	☐	☐	☐	☐
hen	☐	☐	☐	☐
ten	☐	☐	☐	☐
pen	☐	☐	☐	☐
jet	☐	☐	☐	☐
web	☐	☐	☐	☐
red	☐	☐	☐	☐
leg	☐	☐	☐	☐
wet	☐	☐	☐	☐
get	☐	☐	☐	☐
Score / 10	_____	_____	_____	_____

What did you notice? (the eval page uses this)

Which sound slipped • speed or accuracy • did the miss change week to week • did they self-correct

.....

.....

Move-on signal: 8 of 10 across two probes in a row. Mastery criteria in phonics commonly sit at 80–90% accuracy; we ask for 80% twice rather than 90% once, so a single good day does not look like mastery.

ALL FIVE VOWELS.

Ten words, one from each unit and then some. Read them out loud in order.

cat**pig****dog****bug****bed****map****six****box****sun****ten**

Give this after unit 5, then again a month later. A student who holds 8 of 10 here has the whole short-vowel set, not just the last unit you taught.

DATE

.....

SCORE

— / 10

MIXED REVIEW • DATA SHEET

Which vowel slipped tells you which tab to go back to. That is the whole point of a mixed probe.

Probe word	Vowel	First try	One month later
cat	a	☐	☐
pig	i	☐	☐
dog	o	☐	☐
bug	u	☐	☐
bed	e	☐	☐
map	a	☐	☐
six	i	☐	☐
box	o	☐	☐
sun	u	☐	☐
ten	e	☐	☐
Score / 10	—	---	---

Which vowel needs another pass?

.....

.....

If two misses share a vowel, reopen that tab for a week rather than re-teaching the whole binder.
If the misses are scattered across vowels, the gap is blending speed, not any one sound.

AI GROWTH EVAL • one student

Find the score from the data sheet. Read across. No technology needed for any of this.

0-4

The sound is not secure yet.

- Drop back to letter-sound work with just **a** — three minutes daily.
- Use the sound-box page before the writing pages.
- Re-probe in one week with the same ten words.

5-7

Blending is emerging but not automatic.

- Stay in the unit; keep the Build-It step rather than jumping to writing.
- Compare Practice 1 and Practice 2 — if only the no-picture page slipped, the pictures were decoding for them.
- Re-probe in one week; move at 8 twice in a row.

8-10

Short a is solid. Move.

- Start Unit 2 (short i); keep short a alive in mixed review.
- Spot-check short a again in three weeks.

OPTIONAL • IF YOU USE AN AI ASSISTANT

"I teach 2nd grade. A student scored 6 out of 10 on a short-vowel CVC probe. The misses were all words ending in -g and -m, and they self-corrected twice. Give me three specific next steps for this week and one way to check whether it worked."

Describe the grade and the pattern — never a name, never a class list. The student never uses the tool.

Honest limits: ten words is a signal, not a diagnosis. Use it to choose this week's move, alongside everything else you know about the reader.

GROUP SNAPSHOT • WHO NEEDS WHAT

Record the group by student number — S1, S2, S3 — not by name. The pattern across the group tells you how to split your minutes next week.

Student	Score /10	Which words missed	Group
S1	---	-----	---
S2	---	-----	---
S3	---	-----	---
S4	---	-----	---
S5	---	-----	---
S6	---	-----	---

Re-teach

0–4 • daily sound work

Practise

5–7 • stay in unit

Move on

8–10 twice • next unit

OPTIONAL • LET AI DO THE SORTING

"Here are short-vowel CVC probe scores for a 2nd-grade group, out of 10, with the words each one missed. S1: 6 (bag, rag, jam, van). S2: 9 (jam). S3: 7 (bag, rag, jam). S4: 6 (rag, jam, bag, van). S5: 9 (rag). S6: 4 (bag, rag, jam, van, sad, hat). Group them into re-teach / practise / move on, tell me the sound pattern most of the group is missing, and suggest how to split 20 minutes of small-group time across the three groups tomorrow."

Student numbers only — S1, S2, S3. No names, no initials, nothing about the child beyond the score and the words missed.

Why this works: the words each student missed carry more information than the score. In the example above, five of six students read cat, map, pan, sad, hat and tap correctly and missed bag, rag or jam — the vowel is the same in every one of those words, so short a is not the problem. The final sounds -g and -m are. That is a fifteen-minute lesson, not a re-teach of the whole unit.

HOW THIS BINDER IS BUILT

What we based it on, what we are claiming, and what we are not.

The instructional structure

Each of the five units links speech sounds to letters and then asks the student to decode, build and write the same words. That mirrors the two **strong-evidence** recommendations in the IES / What Works Clearinghouse practice guide for K–3 foundational skills: *"Develop awareness of the segments of sounds in speech and how they link to letters"* and *"Teach students to decode words, analyze word parts, and write and recognize words."*

The 8-of-10 move-on signal

Mastery criteria in phonics commonly sit between 80% and 100% accuracy, with 90% often cited. We ask for 80% on two consecutive probes rather than 90% once, because repeating the criterion is what separates a good day from a secure skill. Adjust it to match whatever your school already uses — the data sheet works either way.

What we are not claiming

This binder is not aligned to, affiliated with, or a substitute for any named phonics program, and it is not a diagnostic assessment. It is practice material and a ten-word progress check. Every target word in this binder is a true CVC word — one consonant, one short vowel, one consonant — with no blends or digraphs, verified by an automated check before publication, so the probe measures the one thing it says it measures.

References

Foorman, B., Beyler, N., Borradaile, K., Coyne, M., Denton, C. A., Dimino, J., Furgeson, J., Hayes, L., Henke, J., Justice, L., Keating, B., Lewis, W., Sattar, S., Streke, A., Wagner, R., & Wissel, S. (2016). *Foundational skills to support reading for understanding in kindergarten through 3rd grade* (NCEE 2016-4008). National Center for Education Evaluation and Regional Assistance, Institute of Education Sciences, U.S. Department of Education. Revised December 2019.

Phonics Hero. *Mastery in phonics learning*. — summary of criterion levels used in phonics research (80–100%, with 90% most commonly cited).

Built and audited by two certified teachers. The mixed-review probe at the back checks all five vowels together. If you find an error in any word list or probe, message us through TPT and we will fix it and re-upload the same day — you keep the updated file free.